

LoveShack-B52 -- Love Shack (The B-52's, 1989, ~134 BPM)

Song context

This is a party-rock dance bassline -- bouncy, syncopated, staccato hits that drive the whole groove.

No wash, no smear, no low-end mud -- every note has to pop cleanly through a busy arrangement (surf guitar, organ stabs, group vocals, cowbell).

Tone is bright, punchy, and a little funky -- the "boing" character comes from staccato playing and compression, not from any modulation or octave trick.

This song is clean throughout -- no need to fake grit into it.

Two states:

- **CTL off** -- the verse groove. Bouncy, syncopated, contained.
- **CTL on** -- the "Love Shack, baby" chorus hook. Same core tone, pushed louder and a little grittier to match the call-and-response energy and the full-band chorus hit.

GP-5 settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB

- **NR -- Gate:** THRE 15. Always on.

Light touch -- this bassline is busy and mostly legato-staccato, not much dead space to worry about, so the gate just needs to catch open-string noise.

- **PRE -- Boost:** Gain 60, +3dB on, Bright on. **CTL module** -- off in CTL off, on in CTL on.

First half of the chorus lift -- pushes level and brightness for "Love Shack, baby."

- **DST -- Bass OD:** Gain 45, Blend 40, VOL 70, Bass 55, Treble 65. **CTL module** -- off in CTL off, on in CTL on.

Second half of the chorus lift. Blend at 40 keeps the low end clean underneath while stacking in upper-harmonic edge -- gives the chorus a little extra bite and excitement without turning into a distorted bass tone. Paired with PRE Boost, this is the full verse-to-chorus jump.

- **AMP -- Classic Bass** (Ampeg SVT): Gain 45, Bass 62, Middle 60, MidFreq 1.6kHz, Treble 60, VOL 78. Always on.

SVT again for the same reason as any big, present rock/pop bass tone -- punchy, not scooped. MidFreq pushed up to 1.6kHz (brighter than a typical SVT setting) for the funkier, poppier upper-mid snap this song wants over a heavier low-mid growl.

- **CAB -- AMPG 4x10** (Ampeg SVT-410HE): VOL 70. Always on.

Standard SVT pairing. No bass IR available in the current pack, so built-in CAB is the right call, not a fallback.

- **EQ -- Bass EQ 2:** 50Hz +4, 120Hz +2, 400Hz -5, 800Hz +6, 4.5kHz +6, VOL 55. Always on.

400Hz cut clears out boxiness so the staccato hits stay punchy instead of thick. 800Hz push adds funk snap,

4.5kHz push adds the bright top-end "pop" this bouncy line needs to cut through the surf guitar and organ.

- **MOD -- off.**

No modulation on this bass at all -- see Joyo Narcissus note below, this song doesn't want any chorus wash.

- **DLY -- off.**

Delay would smear the syncopation this part depends on. Stays dry.

- **RVB -- off.**

Same reasoning -- this bass needs to stay tight and up-front, not spacious.

CTL footswitch

- **CTL off** -- verse groove. PRE Boost and Bass OD both bypassed. Default resting state, where the patch loads.

- **CTL on** -- chorus hook. Both PRE Boost and Bass OD engaged together -- louder and a touch grittier, matching the full-band "Love Shack, baby" hit.

- Engage CTL for every chorus hit; drop back to CTL off for verses and the spoken/sung "tin roof... rusted" section, which sits back in the groove rather than pushing forward.

Full pedalboard (signal chain order)

Flamma FS-08 Octave -- bypassed for the entire song (footswitch off, true bypass).

This bassline's bounce comes from staccato playing and compression, not an octave layer -- adding one here would turn a real bass line into something closer to a synth-bass patch, which isn't the vibe.

Donner Ultimate Comp -- engaged for the entire song.

COMP 60, TONE 65, LEVEL 60, Mode: TREBLE.

Slightly heavier compression than a typical clean-bass patch -- this line is all staccato pops and syncopated hits, and consistent compression is what gives it that springy, "boing" consistency note to note. TREBLE mode keeps the attack articulate.

Donner Stylish Fuzz -- bypassed for the entire song (footswitch off, true bypass).

No fuzz texture anywhere in this song -- leave it fully out of the chain.

Joyo Tidal Wave -- engaged for the entire song, light drive character.

Drive 30, Blend 35, Presence 60, Level 55, Treble 60, Middle 55, Bass 50.

Mid-Frequency: 1000Hz (pick/finger attack and cut-through -- right call for this funkier, more percussive line, vs. a "body"-focused 500Hz).

Bass-Shift: 80Hz (tight, articulate -- keeps the staccato hits defined instead of blurring together).

Cab-Sim (DI out): on, if running a DI to FOH. Ground Lift: off unless hum shows up.

Drive stays low -- gentle analog thickening and preamp/EQ shaping, not audible dirt. The main gain difference for the chorus comes from the GP-5's CTL switch, not this pedal.

Joyo Narcissus -- bypassed for the entire song (footswitch off).

No chorus anywhere in this patch, pedal or GP-5 MOD module -- this bassline needs to stay dry and punchy. Any wash would blur the syncopation that makes this groove work.

Valeton GP-5 -- see settings above.

Instrument notes (P/J bass)

Balance both pickup volumes close to even, maybe a slight favor to the J (bridge) pickup here -- this line wants pick/finger attack and top-end snap more than low-end weight.

Tone knob open, most of the way up. Bright and present is the whole point of this tone.